

SOUTH KOREA

A Relaxed Winter Week

Shopping • Fried Chicken • Korean BBQ • Slow Mornings

A 7-day, semi-structured winter itinerary designed around slow mornings, great food, and plenty of unscheduled time to wander and shop. Each day has one or two anchor activities and meals; everything else is left open so the trip can flex around mood, weather, and whatever looks interesting that day.

Destination	Seoul, South Korea (with an optional day trip)
Duration	7 days / 6 nights
Season	Winter (Dec–Feb, expect approx. -5°C to 5°C)
Pace	Relaxed & semi-structured — 1–2 anchor activities per day, rest is free time
Focus	Shopping districts, fried chicken, Korean BBQ, casual sightseeing
Base	One central hotel/stay for the whole week (suggested: Myeongdong, Hongdae, or Jung-gu)

How this schedule works

Each day is built loosely around **one main area of the city** so travel time stays low. Mornings start late (this is a relaxing trip, not a race). Meal times are suggested, not fixed — swap them around freely. Anything marked *Free / Open* is intentionally unplanned: wander, shop, people-watch, or revisit a spot that was too good to leave.



FRIED CHICKEN



KOREAN BBQ



SHOPPING



FREE / OPEN



DAY 1

Arrival Day | Base area: Myeongdong

Theme: Land, settle in, ease into the city



Midday	Arrive Incheon/Gimpo, transfer to hotel, check in (or store luggage if too early).
Afternoon	No plans on purpose — nap, shower, or take a slow first walk around the hotel block to get oriented.  FREE / OPEN
Early Evening	Welcome dinner: order a first round of Korean fried chicken and beer (chi-maek) at a casual local spot near Myeongdong.  FRIED CHICKEN
Evening	Wander Myeongdong's main shopping strip — cosmetics stores, street food stalls, and window shopping. No agenda, just soak it in.  SHOPPING

DAY 2

Day 2 | Base area: Myeongdong / Namdaemun

Theme: Slow start, markets and street food



Late Morning	Sleep in. Lazy café breakfast near the hotel.  FREE / OPEN
Midday	Namdaemun Market — Korea's oldest traditional market. Browse stalls at whatever pace feels right.  SHOPPING
Afternoon	Open block: keep exploring Namdaemun/Myeongdong, or head back to the hotel to warm up and rest.  FREE / OPEN
Evening	First proper Korean BBQ dinner — samgyeopsal (pork belly) or galbi at a local grill house.  KOREAN BBQ
Night	Optional: dessert cafe crawl or an early night — no fixed plan.  FREE / OPEN

DAY 3

Day 3 | Base area: Hongdae

Theme: Youth culture, indie shopping, casual wandering



Late Morning	Slow brunch — Hongdae has plenty of relaxed cafés to pick from on the day.  FREE / OPEN
Midday	Hongdae shopping streets: fashion boutiques, indie brands, K-pop merch, and street stalls.  SHOPPING
Afternoon	Unstructured time to duck into whatever shops or street performances catch the eye.  FREE / OPEN
Evening	Dinner at one of Hongdae's well-known fried chicken spots — try a flavour beyond the classic (e.g. soy garlic or spicy).  FRIED CHICKEN
Night	Hongdae nightlife area is walkable if he wants a low-key look, otherwise head back and rest.  FREE / OPEN

DAY 4

Day 4 | Base area: Gangnam / Apgujeong

Theme: Upscale shopping, easy sightseeing



Late Morning	Slow morning; head to Gangnam once ready — no set departure time.  FREE / OPEN
Midday	Gangnam Underground Shopping Centre and COEX Mall (also home to the famous Starfield Library) — mostly indoors, good for a cold day.  SHOPPING
Afternoon	Optional wander through Apgujeong Rodeo Street for higher-end boutiques, or simply relax indoors at COEX.  FREE / OPEN
Evening	Korean BBQ dinner in Gangnam — beef-focused (hanwoo) if he wants to treat himself one night.  KOREAN BBQ

DAY 5

Day 5 | Base area: Bukchon & Ikseon-dong

Theme: Light sightseeing, hanbok streets, easy pace



Late Morning	Slow start; this is the lightest sightseeing day, kept deliberately unhurried.  FREE / OPEN
Midday	Optional short visit to Gyeongbokgung Palace or Bukchon Hanok Village — purely optional, easy to skip if he'd rather just wander.  FREE / OPEN



Afternoon	Ikseon-dong's laneways — small boutiques, hanbok rental shops, and gift stores in a restored hanok neighbourhood.  SHOPPING
Evening	Dinner: fried chicken in Ikseon-dong or nearby Jongno, in a cosy, low-key setting.  FRIED CHICKEN

DAY 6

Day 6 | Base area: Dongdaemun (or optional day trip)

Theme: Late-night shopping or optional day trip out of the city



Late Morning	Rest morning — this is the last full day, so keep it light.  FREE / OPEN
Midday	Optional half-day trip out of Seoul (e.g. Nami Island or an ice/snow festival if timing lines up) — otherwise stay local and relax.  FREE / OPEN
Afternoon	Dongdaemun Design Plaza area and Dongdaemun Market — famous for round-the-clock shopping.  SHOPPING
Evening	Farewell-style Korean BBQ dinner — a chance to revisit a favourite cut or try something new.  KOREAN BBQ
Night	Dongdaemun's shopping malls stay open late into the night if he's up for one more browse; otherwise wind down.  SHOPPING

DAY 7

Departure Day | Base area: Myeongdong / Airport

Theme: Last-minute shopping, easy departure



Morning	Slow last morning — pack, grab a final café breakfast.  FREE / OPEN
Late Morning	Any last-minute souvenir or cosmetics shopping near the hotel before checkout.  SHOPPING
Midday	One last fried chicken meal if time allows, or grab something quick near the station.  FRIED CHICKEN
Afternoon	Transfer to the airport for departure.



Notes & Flexibility

This schedule is intentionally loose. Any day's *Free / Open* blocks can be swapped for extra rest, an extra meal, or moved to another neighbourhood entirely. If a shopping street or restaurant turns out to be a highlight, there's no obligation to move on — the itinerary is a guide, not a fixed plan. Winter in Seoul can get cold and dry, so indoor malls (COEX, Dongdaemun, Lotte) are useful backup options on especially cold days.

